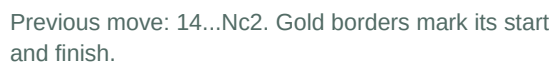


Deflection tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: pawn on e7.



15. Qc6+ Qd7 16. Qxa8+ Qd8 17. Qc6+

16.Qxa8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on a8. Recorded reply: **16...Qd8**.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.